

Absolutely — **business** is a very strong polysemy target because your passage uses it several times:

- > “A successful small **business** that I know about is a neighbourhood bakery...”
- > “I think this **business** is successful for several reasons.”
- > “With food **businesses**...”
- > “In **business**, that is often half the battle.”

These are actually **not all identical uses**. The first two refer to **an individual commercial enterprise/company**, while **food businesses** refers to companies operating in a particular sector, and **in business** can refer more broadly to **commercial activity/the world of commerce**.

Word family: **business / businessperson / businessman / businesswoman / businesslike**

Base word: business

Plural: businesses

Related person nouns: businessperson, businessman, businesswoman

Related adjective: businesslike

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / attributive noun (名詞作前置修飾語)

Pronunciation:

- > **business** /'biznəs/

The spelling may tempt learners to pronounce all the written vowels, but the usual pronunciation is roughly:

- > **BIZ-nuhs**

Meaning 1 in your passage: **business** = a commercial enterprise/company — 生意；企業；商戶

Your opening sentence:

- > “A successful small **business** that I know about is a neighbourhood bakery...”

Here **business** means:

- > **an organization or commercial activity operated to sell goods or services, usually to earn money.**

繁體中文：

向顧客提供商品或服務、通常以賺取收入或利潤為目的的商業機構 / 生意

Natural translation:

> “A successful small business that I know about is a neighbourhood bakery...”

「我知道的一間成功**小生意 / 小型企業**是一間社區麵包店.....」

So here:

> **business = 一間生意 / 企業**

Practice 1 — Source

> “A successful small **business** that I know about is a neighbourhood bakery.”

「我知道的一間成功**小生意 / 小型企業**是一間社區麵包店。」

Practice 2

> “She started a small **business** selling handmade cakes.”

「她開了一間售賣手工蛋糕的**小生意**。」

Practice 3

> “The family has run the business for more than twenty years.”

「這個家庭經營這盤**生意 / 企業**超過二十年。」

business — enterprise = 一間獨立經營、提供商品或服務的商業機構

Meaning 2 in your passage: **business = commercial activity in general — 商業；做生意；營商活動**

Your sentence:

> “In **business**, that is often half the battle.”

Here **business** is broader. It means:

> **the activity or world of buying, selling, managing companies, and earning money commercially.**

****繁體中文：****

****買賣、經營企業、提供商品 / 服務等商業活動整體；商業、營商****

Natural translation:

> “In business, that is often half the battle.”

「在****做生意 / 營商****方面，這往往已經成功了一大半。」

1. ****business = commercial activity generally — 商業；營商；做生意****

Practice 4

> “She has worked in ****business**** for many years.”

「她從事****商業 / 企業界工作****很多年了。」

Practice 5

> “Trust is important in business.”

「****做生意****時，信任很重要。」

****business = 商業活動以及企業經營這個整體領域****

2. ****business = a particular type/sector of commercial activity — 行業；產業****

This appears in:

> “With food ****businesses****...”

and also in expressions such as:

* the fashion business

* the film business

* the restaurant business

Practice 6

> “The restaurant ****business**** is highly competitive.”

「餐飲**行業**競爭非常激烈。」

Practice 7

> “He has worked in the music business for years.”

「他在音樂**行業**工作多年。」

business = 某一類商品 / 服務所形成的商業行業

This is different from one individual company.

Compare:

> **a food business**

> = 一間食品企業

> **the food business**

> = 食品行業

3. **business = work connected with one's job/company — 公事；業務**

A major workplace meaning.

Practice 8

> “I’m travelling to Tokyo on **business**.”

「我要到東京**出公差 / 辦公事**。」

Practice 9

> “We have some business to discuss.”

「我們有一些**公事 / 業務**要談。」

business = 與工作、公司、交易或職務有關的事情

This gives us:

> **business trip** = 商務旅行 / 出差

> **business meeting** = 商務會議

4. ****business = matters that concern someone — 事情；事務****

A major non-commercial meaning.

Practice 10

> “That is my ****business****, not yours.”

「那是****我的事****，不是你的事。」

Practice 11

> “What I do in my free time is my own business.”

「我空閒時間做甚麼是****我自己的事****。」

****business = 某人有權處理、決定或關心的私人 / 個人事務****

This has nothing to do with commerce.

5. ****none of your business = 不關你的事****

A very common fixed expression.

Practice 12

> “Where I go is ****none of your business****.”

「我去哪裡****不關你的事****。」

Practice 13

> “How much I paid is none of his business.”

「我付了多少錢****不關他的事****。」

****none of someone's business = 某事不屬於某人的權限 / 關心範圍****

Register:

* conversational

* can sound rude or defensive

6. **mind your own business = 管好你自己的事；別多管閒事**

A common idiom worth flagging.

Practice 14

> “Why don’t you **mind your own business**?”

「你為甚麼不**管好自己的事 / 別多管閒事**？」

Practice 15

> “He told them to mind their own business.”

「他叫他們**不要多管閒事**。」

mind your own business = 不要干涉別人的私人事務

This is idiomatic rather than a separate lexical meaning of bare **business**.

7. **business = task / matter that needs attention — 正事；要處理的事情**

A useful general meaning.

Practice 16

> “Let’s get down to **business**.”

「我們開始談**正事**吧。」

Practice 17

> “We have unfinished business.”

「我們還有**未完成的事情 / 正事**要處理。」

business = 需要處理、完成或認真面對的事情

This is broader than paid work.

8. **get down to business = 開始辦正事**

Practice 18

> “After a few minutes of chatting, we got down to **business**.”

「聊了幾分鐘後，我們便開始**談正事**。」

Practice 19

> “Let’s get down to business and discuss the budget.”

「我們開始**談正事**，討論一下預算吧。」

get down to business = 停止閒聊，開始認真處理主要事情

9. **unfinished business = 未了的事情；尚未處理完的問題**

Practice 20

> “She returned because she had some **unfinished business**.”

「她回來是因為還有一些**未了的事情**。」

Practice 21

> “The disagreement left unfinished business between them.”

「那場爭執令他們之間留下一些**尚未解決的問題**。」

unfinished business = 尚未完成、解決或處理的事情

10. **business = customers / commercial transactions — 生意量；營業**

A major commercial sense.

Practice 22

> “**Business** was slow this morning.”

「今天早上的**生意很淡**。」

Practice 23

> “The bakery does a lot of business at lunchtime.”

「這間麵包店午飯時間的**生意很好 / 交易很多**。」

business = 顧客帶來的交易量或營業活動

Important contrast:

> “The business is small.”

> = 公司 / 生意規模小

> “Business is slow.”

> = 生意淡 / 客少

No article can signal a different meaning.

11. **do business with + person/company = 與.....做生意 / 有商業往來**

Practice 24

> “The bakery does business with several local suppliers.”

「這間麵包店與幾家本地供應商**有生意往來**。」

Practice 25

> “We no longer do business with that company.”

「我們已不再與那家公司**做生意**。」

do business with = 與某人 / 機構進行商業交易或合作

12. **go into business = 開始經商 ; 創業**

A common business expression.

Practice 26

> “She went into **business** after leaving university.”

「她大學畢業後開始**經商**。」

Practice 27

> “They went into business together.”

「他們一起**創業 / 做生意**。」

go into business = 開始從事商業活動，尤其是自己經營企業

13. **go out of business = 結業；倒閉**

A very high-value expression.

Practice 28

> “Several small shops went out of **business**.”

「幾間小店**結業 / 倒閉**了。」

Practice 29

> “The company nearly went out of business during the crisis.”

「公司在危機期間差點**倒閉**。」

go out of business = 停止營業，通常因無法繼續經營

14. **be in business = 正在營業；從事商業活動**

Practice 30

> “The bakery has been **in business** for ten years.”

「這間麵包店已經**營業 / 經營**十年。」

Practice 31

> “They have been in business since 2015.”

「他們從 2015 年開始一直**經營生意**。」

****be in business = 正在從事商業經營 / 企業仍然營運****

15. ****be back in business = 恢復正常運作；又可以開始了****

A figurative extension.

Practice 32

> “The oven is fixed, so we’re ****back in business****.”

「焗爐修好了，我們又可以****恢復正常營業 / 運作****了。」

Practice 33

> “Once the system restarted, we were back in business.”

「系統重新啟動後，我們便****恢復正常運作****。」

****back in business = 問題解決後重新可以工作、營運或繼續進行****

This can be used outside literal commerce.

16. ****business = serious purpose / intention — 正經目的；認真態度****

This survives in expressions such as:

> mean business

Practice 34

> “When the manager arrived early, everyone knew she ****meant business****.”

「經理提早到場時，大家都知道她這次是****認真的 / 要動真格****。」

Practice 35

> “His tone showed that he meant business.”

「他的語氣顯示他是****認真來真的****。」

****mean business = 對某事非常認真，並打算採取實際行動****

Again, idiomatic, but very useful.

17. **business = situation / affair, especially unpleasant activity (較非正式) — 那回事 ; 那一套事情**

A broader colloquial extension appears in phrases such as:

> “What’s all this business about changing the schedule?”

Practice 36

> “What’s all this **business** about moving the meeting?”

「這一大堆關於改會議時間的**事情 / 說法**是怎麼回事？」

Practice 37

> “I don’t understand this business with the missing files.”

「我不明白這些遺失檔案的**事情到底是怎麼回事**。」

business = 某個正在發生、令人困惑或需要處理的事情 / 情況

Register:

* informal

* context-dependent

Secondary, but genuine.

18. **business = profession/occupation (較舊式 / 正式) — 職業 ; 行當**

A secondary traditional meaning that remains in certain constructions.

Practice 38

> “Teaching is a demanding **business**.”

「教學是一門很費心力的**工作 / 行當**。」

Practice 39

> “Running a restaurant is a difficult business.”

「經營餐廳是一門很不容易的**行當**。」

****business = 某種工作、活動或行當，尤其當說話者評論其性質時****

This often overlaps with “activity/field”, so I would keep it secondary rather than split it too aggressively.

19. ****business + noun = 商業 / 工作相關的****

****Business** frequently acts attributively.**

Common:

- * business meeting
- * business trip
- * business plan
- * business model
- * business hours
- * business relationship

Practice 40

> “She is away on a ****business trip****.”

「她正在****出差 / 商務旅行****。」

Practice 41

> “We exchanged business cards after the meeting.”

「會議後我們交換了****名片****。」

****business + noun = 與公司、商業活動、工作或交易有關的****

20. ****business hours = 營業時間；辦公時間****

Practice 42

> “Please call during ****business hours****.”

「請在**辦公 / 營業時間**內致電。」

Practice 43

> “The bakery’s business hours are posted on the door.”

「麵包店的**營業時間**貼在門上。」

****business hours = 公司 / 商店正常對外營業或辦公的時間****

21. ****businessperson = 商人 ; 企業人士****

A useful neutral person noun.

Practice 44

> “She is a successful ****businessperson****.”

「她是一位成功的****商人 / 企業人士****。」

Practice 45

> “Local businesspeople supported the event.”

「本地****商界人士****支持這項活動。」

****businessperson = 經營企業或從事商業活動的人****

This is gender-neutral.

22. ****businessman / businesswoman = 男商人 / 女商人 ; 企業家****

Practice 46

> “He became a successful ****businessman****.”

「他成為了一位成功的****商人 / 企業家****。」

Practice 47

> “She is a well-known businesswoman in the city.”

「她是城中一位知名的**女企業家 / 商界人士**。」

These remain common, though **businessperson** is the neutral umbrella term.

23. **businesslike** = 有效率而務實的；公事公辦的**

A useful family extension.

Practice 48

> “She gave a short, **businesslike** answer.”

「她給了一個簡短而**務實乾脆的**回答。」

Practice 49

> “The meeting was friendly but businesslike.”

「會議氣氛友善，但仍然很**公事公辦、有效率**。」

businesslike = 做事有條理、直接、務實，集中於完成工作**

It does **not** simply mean:

> “related to business.”

Important distinction: **business vs company**

You already mapped **company**.

business

can mean:

- * one commercial enterprise;
- * commercial activity;
- * trade;
- * work matters.

company

primarily means:

- * a particular organization/business entity;
- * or companionship in another sense.

So:

> “She owns a small business.”

very natural.

> “She owns a small company.”

also possible, but emphasizes the organization.

A sole trader can run a **business** without necessarily operating a formally incorporated **company**.

Important distinction: **business** vs **shop**

Your source is a bakery.

shop

= physical retail premises.

business

= the commercial operation as a whole.

The bakery may have:

> one shop

but the **business** includes:

- * employees
- * customers
- * finances
- * products
- * suppliers
- * brand
- * operations

Important distinction: **business vs trade**

business

broader:

all commercial activity or an individual enterprise.

trade

often emphasizes buying/selling or a particular skilled/commercial sector.

> international trade

> = 國際貿易

> family business

> = 家族生意

They overlap but are not interchangeable everywhere.

Important distinction: **business vs industry**

business

can be an individual company or commercial activity.

industry

usually means the entire sector made up of many related companies.

> a bakery business

> = 一間麵包店生意

> baking industry

> = 烘焙產業

Important distinction: **business vs commerce**

commerce

more formal:

buying and selling goods/services, especially on a broad scale.

business

far more flexible:

can refer to one company, the activity, the field, or work matters.

> Department of Commerce

> = 商務 / 商業部門

> small business

> = 小型企業

Important distinction: **business vs enterprise**

enterprise

can mean:

* a business organization;

* an ambitious undertaking.

business

is the everyday general term for commercial operations.

> small business

> is much more ordinary than:

> small enterprise

although both are possible.

Important distinction: **business vs occupation**

occupation

= a person's job/profession.

business

can describe commercial work or, in certain constructions, an activity/line of work.

> “What is your occupation?”

> = 你的職業是甚麼？

not normally:

> “What is your business?”

> unless asking what line/company/activity they are involved in.

Important distinction: **business vs affair**

business

in:

> “none of your business”

means:

> 私人事務 / 關你甚麼事

affair

can also mean:

matter/situation, often more formal, and has additional meanings.

They overlap only in certain contexts.

Important distinction: **business — company vs trade volume**

Very important article contrast:

Countable enterprise

> “The **business** is doing well.”

= 這間公司 / 生意經營得很好。

Uncountable commercial activity

> “**Business** is good.”

= 生意很好 / 客源很好。

So:

> ****a business**** = 一間企業 / 一盤生意

> ****business**** = 生意活動 / 營業情況

Excellent MCQ material.

Important distinction: ****business — commerce vs personal matter****

Commercial:

> “He runs a business.”

= 他經營生意。

Personal:

> “That is none of your business.”

= 那不關你的事。

Same word, completely different modern meanings.

Important distinction: ****business — sector vs individual company****

****a food business****

= 一間從事食品業的企業

****the food business****

= 食品行業 / 食品生意這個領域

Your passage contains the plural:

> “With food businesses...”

which means:

> ****食品 / 餐飲類企業****

Important distinction: ****on business vs for business****

****on business****

= 因公 / 出差

> “She is in London on business.”

「她因公在倫敦。」

****for business****

usually means:

= 為了商業用途

> “I use this phone for business.”

「我用這部手機處理公事。」

Different constructions.

Important distinction: ****business trip vs holiday****

****business trip****

= 因工作而出行

****holiday****

= 休假旅行

A trip can combine both, but the primary purpose differs.

Important distinction: ****businesslike vs business****

****business****

> business meeting

> = 商務會議

****businesslike****

> businesslike manner

> = 務實、有效率、公事公辦的態度

****Businesslike**** describes manner/style, not commercial subject matter.

Important distinction: ****businessperson vs entrepreneur****

****businessperson****

= anyone professionally engaged in business.

****entrepreneur****

= especially someone who starts/builds businesses and accepts commercial risk.

Every entrepreneur is broadly a businessperson, but not every businessperson is an entrepreneur.

Family-extension sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern family includes:

- * ****business — individual enterprise**** = 生意 / 企業
- * ****business — commerce generally**** = 商業 / 營商
- * ****business — industry/sector**** = 行業
- * ****business — work matters**** = 公事 / 業務
- * ****business — personal matters**** = 私人事務 / 某人的事
- * ****business — task/matter**** = 正事 / 待處理事項
- * ****business — trade volume**** = 生意量 / 營業
- * ****do business with**** = 與.....做生意
- * ****go into business**** = 開始經商 / 創業
- * ****go out of business**** = 結業 / 倒閉
- * ****be in business**** = 營業 / 經營
- * ****back in business**** = 恢復運作
- * ****get down to business**** = 開始談正事
- * ****unfinished business**** = 未了事情
- * ****none of your business**** = 不關你的事
- * ****mind your own business**** = 別多管閒事
- * ****mean business**** = 認真 / 動真格
- * ****business + noun**** = 商業 / 工作相關
- * ****business hours**** = 營業 / 辦公時間
- * ****businessperson**** = 商人 / 商界人士

* **businessman** = 男商人 / 企業家
 * **businesswoman** = 女商人 / 企業家
 * **businesslike** = 務實有效率 / 公事公辦的

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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business — enterprise	向顧客提供商品 / 服務、通常以賺取收入為目的的一間商業機構
business — commerce	買賣、經營企業、提供商品 / 服務等商業活動整體
business — sector	某一類商品 / 服務所形成的商業行業
business — work matters	與工作、公司、交易或職務相關的公事 / 業務
business — personal matter	某人有權決定、處理或關心的私人事務
business — matter/task	需要認真處理、完成或解決的事情
business — trade volume	顧客交易所形成的營業活動 / 生意量
do business with	與某人 / 機構進行商業交易或合作
go into business	開始從事商業活動，尤其自己經營企業
go out of business	因無法繼續經營而停止營業 / 倒閉
be in business	正在營業或從事商業經營
back in business	問題解決後恢復工作 / 運作
get down to business	停止閒聊並開始處理主要事情
unfinished business	尚未完成、解決或處理的事情
none of your business	某件事不屬於你的權限 / 關心範圍
mean business	對某事非常認真並打算採取實際行動
businessperson	經營企業或專業從事商業活動的人
businesslike	做事直接、有條理、務實並集中於完成工作

For your original passage

The passage contains several useful **business** uses:

> “A successful small **business** ...”

= **一間小型企業 / 小生意**

> “I think this **business** is successful...”

= **這間企業 / 這盤生意**

> “With food **businesses** ...”

= **食品 / 餐飲類企業**

> “In **business**, that is often half the battle.”

= **在營商 / 做生意這個領域中**

So the highest-value contrasts are:

> **a business** → 一間企業 / 一盤生意

> **business in general** → 商業 / 營商

> **the food business** → 食品行業

> **business matters** → 公事 / 業務

> **none of your business** → 不關你的事

> **business is good** → 生意很好

> **go out of business** → 結業 / 倒閉

> **get down to business** → 開始談正事

> **mean business** → 認真 / 動真格

> **businesslike** → 務實有效率 / 公事公辦的